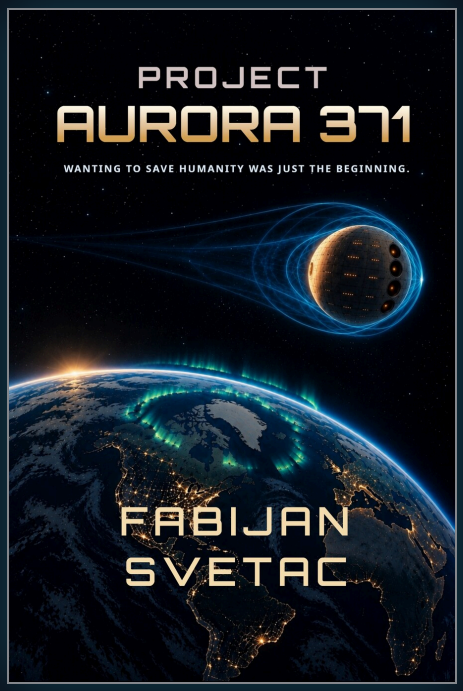


PRESS KIT · 2026

PROJECT AURORA 371

Wanting to save humanity was just the beginning.

FABIJAN D. SVETAC

Hard science fiction · generation ship · colonization

> In 2048, a geophysicist finds numbers in Earth's data that shouldn't exist: the planet's magnetic shield is failing. Decades later, a secret Guild launches the Aurora, a spherical ark carrying 82 people to a world 200 light-years away. A hard science fiction saga about what it costs to start again.

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FOR READERS OF	*Seveneves* (Neal Stephenson) · *Children of Time* (Adrian Tchaikovsky) · *Aurora* (Kim Stanley Robinson)

THE BOOK

Synopsis

In 2048, a young geophysicist finds numbers in Earth's own data that shouldn't exist. The world doesn't listen. By the time it does, it's too late to fix what's coming. It's not too late to build something else.

For thirty years, scientists, executives and unlikely believers who call themselves the Guild build an interstellar ark in secret. Alder Campbell is not one of them. He is not a scientist, an engineer or a pilot. He becomes the one thing the mission needs most: someone people can trust.

Alder boards the Aurora alone. His wife has chosen to stay on Earth; his two sons will grow old on a planet he will never see again. On the long crossing, a ship built to outrun a dying world must become something no one designed: a society that can raise children, keep secrets, and decide who gets to lead.

Project Aurora 371 is a hard science fiction saga about what it costs to start again.

THE AUTHOR

Fabijan D. Svetac



Fabijan D. Svetac is a nomad by vocation — a foreigner everywhere he has lived. He fell in love with science fiction as a child and never quite recovered; in school, biology, chemistry and physics held his attention longest, and today he works in software development and systems integration. *Project Aurora 371*, his first novel, keeps circling back to a question he has lived with all his life: what it means to build a home somewhere you don't come from.

MEDIUM BIO

Fabijan D. Svetac writes hard science fiction about technology, human nature, and the future of civilization. Fascinated by the questions that emerge when technological possibility meets human limitation, his work turns to survival, planetary crisis, and the possibility of a future beyond Earth. *Project Aurora 371* is his first novel.

SHORT BIO

Hard science fiction about technology, human nature and the future of civilization. Author of PROJECT AURORA 371.

INTERVIEW

Questions the author is happy to answer

Why is the Aurora a sphere?

> Almost every starship in science fiction is long and pointed. Mine is a ball, and that wasn't a design choice. It was the engine's. The gravitational generator wraps itself in a field that spreads evenly in every direction, a bubble. Build something long and the bubble has to grow to cover the whole hull: more field, more energy, more waste. So the engineers did the opposite. As one of them puts it: "We don't force the field to adapt to the spacecraft. We make the spacecraft adapt to the field."

Your ship shares a name with Kim Stanley Robinson's *Aurora*. Is that deliberate?

> The name comes from the Roman goddess of the dawn, not from his book. She stands for renewal, hope and new beginnings. But I'm glad of the company. His *Aurora* is the strongest case I know against leaving. I gave that case to one of my characters and let her keep it.

How is this different from *Seveneves*?

> Stephenson gives humanity two years to save itself. I gave it ninety, which turns out to be harder: there's time to look away. When the ministers in my book hear "a few decades", they relax. A deadline two years away unites people. A deadline ninety years away tests them.

Chapter 2 already tells us they arrive. Why give that away so early?

> I wanted the reader to stop asking whether they make it and start asking what it cost and who paid. An old man telling a boy how they got there is a different book from a countdown.

Where's the villain?

> There's no villain because I don't think that's where the danger is. The hardest scene in my book is two people who love each other at a kitchen table with a form between them, and both of them are right. I find that more frightening than a saboteur.

TOPICS FOR A GUEST POST OR INTERVIEW

- Designing a starship around its engine instead of its looks.
- Hard SF with a human focus: the science serves a question about people.
- Governing 82 people between the stars: councils, minutes and the archivist as narrator.
- The people who stay behind: what a mission like this costs the families on Earth.

FROM THE BOOK

Excerpts

CHAPTER 1 · THE NUMBERS THAT SHOULDN'T EXIST

The first person to realize that something was wrong was not trying to save humanity.

That winter morning, Dr. Miguel Azevedo was simply trying to find an error in his own calculations.

[...]

The final graph of the simulation did not show a curve.

It showed a date.

Estimated year of irreversible biosphere collapse: 2137.

CHAPTER 2 · A MAN ON THE BALCONY

They knew the facts.

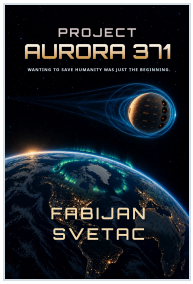
They knew there had been a great expedition. [...] That their parents and grandparents had crossed the void between the stars.

But books taught dates.

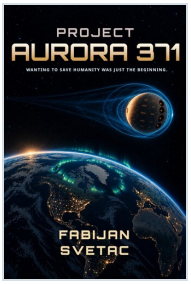
They did not teach people.

Nor did they teach doubt or fear.

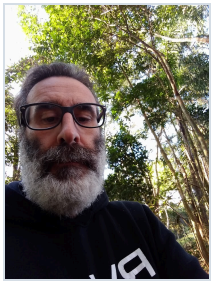
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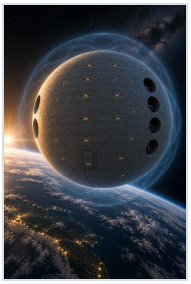
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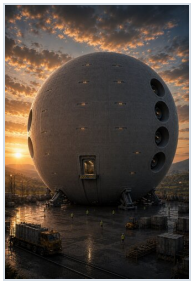
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Author photo
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The Aurora in orbit
AI-generated illustration



The Aurora in dock
AI-generated illustration

REVIEW COPIES

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